



Republic of Zambia

Ministry of Education

LITERATURE IN ENGLISH

TEACHING MODULE

FORM 1-TERM TWO



Published by Curriculum Development Centre

Lusaka

2025



Republic of Zambia

Ministry of Education

Directorate of Curriculum Development

The Curriculum Development Centre

TEACHING MODULE

FORM 1

TERM TWO

@ Curriculum Development Centre 2025

All rights reserved. No parts of this publication may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system or transmitted by electronic, mechanical, photocopying, recording or other means, without prior permission of the Curriculum Development Centre

Authors

Stephen Moyo: Curriculum Development Specialist - English Language, CDC, Lusaka.

Nawa Mushiba: Curriculum Development Specialist - English Language, CDC, Lusaka.

Anderson Lwimbo: Head Teacher, Shimukuni Secondary School, Chibombo.

Charles Kabungo: Education Standards Officer, Kalulushi.

John Moono: Teacher, Mbala Boarding Secondary School, Mbala.

Mathew Kang'ombe: Lecturer, Chalimbana University, Chongwe.

Monde Sinyangwe: Education Standards Officer, Luanshya.

Monica Kamwengo-Imasiku: Teacher, Roma Girls Secondary School, Lusaka.

Mushaukwa Mubuka-Matale: Deputy Head Teacher, Kaunda Square Secondary School, Lusaka.

Namushi Situtu: Senior College Lecturer, Chipata College of Education, Chipata.

PREFACE

The advent of the Competence-Based Curriculum (CBC) heralds a new era of dynamic and practical learning experiences designed to equip learners with the 21st century skills. It marks a trans-formative step in improving education quality and relevance.

The Literature in English Teaching Module for Ordinary level has been designed in line with the Competence Based Education principles which seek to link education to real life experiences. The General Competences provided in the 2023 Zambia Curriculum Framework are linked to the content of this module.

The module aims to support teachers of Literature in English in the implementation of the CBC in the absence of approved textbooks. It therefore reflects the Ministry's unwavering commitment to making this journey as smooth as possible for teachers. However, teachers are encouraged to supplement this module with their own research and innovations in order to address any gaps that may arise during implementation.

I hope teachers will make good use of this resource.

Kelvin Mambwe (PhD.)

Permanent Secretary- Educational Services

MINISTRY OF EDUCATION

Acknowledgement

The Literature in English Teaching Module for Ordinary Level has been developed through a consultative and participatory process. Many individuals, institutions and organizations were consulted and accorded an opportunity to make proposals about the content of this teaching module. I would, therefore, like to express my profound gratitude to individuals, institutions and organizations that provided the financial and technical input to the successful development of this teaching module. These include; Teachers, Lecturers from Colleges of Education and Universities, Subject Associations, Civil Society Organizations, and Cooperating Partners.

Finally, I appreciate the commitment and hard work of the staff at the Directorate of Curriculum Development in ensuring the successful completion of the Teaching Module.

Charles Ndakala, (Dr.)

Director - Curriculum Development

MINISTRY OF EDUCATION

Contents

PREFACE	5
Acknowledgement	6
INTRODUCTION	8
TERM 2- LITERATURE IN ENGLISH –TEACHING AND LEARNING ACTIVITIES	9
TOPIC: 1.2.2 WRITTEN LITERATURE	11
SUBTOPIC: 1.2.2.1. FORMS OF WRITTEN LITERATURE	12
SUB-TOPIC: 1.2.2.2. PROSE	16
BIBLIOGRAPHY	33
SAMPLE LESSON PLAN	34

INTRODUCTION

The Literature in English Teaching Module for Ordinary level has been developed to support teachers in the effective delivery of Literature in English lessons under the reformed curriculum. The module is developed based on the approved 2024 Competence-based Literature in English syllabus. It aims to bridge the gap created by the absence of approved textbooks and to equip educators with activities and assessments tailored to the learners' level and needs.

The Ministry understands the challenges that come with transitioning to a new curriculum that is Competence-Based. The choice of the Competence-Based Curriculum (CBC) marks a transformative step in improving education quality and relevance. This module reflects the Ministry's unwavering commitment to making this journey as smooth as possible for teachers, by providing structured guidance, suggested activities, and formative assessments that align with the CBC's objectives. However, teachers are encouraged to supplement this module with their own research and innovations in order to address any gaps that may arise during implementation.

The suggested activities and assessments provided in this module are designed to foster practical and critical thinking skills in learners while ensuring relevance and adaptability to different school contexts. Teachers are encouraged to tailor these pedagogical skills to their unique classroom dynamics and to explore alternative, acceptable approaches which are learner centred. This flexibility is key to ensuring that all learners, regardless of their environment, benefit from meaningful and impactful Curriculum.

It is envisaged that this module will serve as a valuable resource for teachers as they navigate the new Competence-Based Curriculum, enhancing their ability to inspire and equip learners with essential literary knowledge, skills and positive attitudes desired to create a vibrant and responsive education system.

HOW THE MODULE SHOULD BE USED

This module contains the content scheduled for teaching in the second term of Form 1 Literature in English. It is divided into topics and sub-topics for different components. The content provided in this module are not scripted lessons but should be used to come up with lessons. When preparing lessons, you should draw content from different sources. As you prepare a lesson you must select appropriate teaching and learning activities as well as suggested teaching points. Furthermore, the activities provided for each competence are not meant to be exhausted in one lesson. These can be done in different lessons. Note however that, this module is meant to guide the teacher and not a resource for learners.

SUGGESTED TEACHING METHODOLOGY

Generally, lesson delivery should follow a variety of teaching methods and techniques such as class discussion, role play, simulation, dramatization, multi-media integration and project-based learning.

TERM 2- LITERATURE IN ENGLISH –TEACHING AND LEARNING ACTIVITIES

TOPIC: 1.2.2 WRITTEN LITERATURE

Introduction

This chapter looks at written literature which is one of the types of literature. Written literature is a rich and diverse field that encompasses various artistic works in form of prose, drama and poetry. Together, these forms of written literature offer a wide range of perspectives and experiences, allowing readers to explore different worlds, empathize with characters, and reflect on their own lives. By studying these literary forms, learners will gain a deeper understanding of how writers use language to communicate, inspire, and challenge their audiences.

GENERAL COMPETENCES

The learners will exhibit the following competences:

- Analytical thinking: grasp and breakdown information and effectively share with others.
- Collaboration: learners to participate fully in groups towards accomplishing given tasks.
- Communication: effectively share one's thoughts and emotions and understand others.
- Creativity and innovation: organize information and ideas.
- Critical thinking: analyze texts to improve the ability to understand.
- Digital: upload and download information.
- Emotional intelligence: communicate and relate effectively with others.



KEY TERMS/VOCABULARY

Some key terms/vocabulary to be introduced in this topic include:

- Analyze- to examine something in detail.
- Artistic- showing skill or imagination in design, expression or performance.
- Character- a participant in the action of a story.
- Climax- the highest point of action or suspense in a story.

- Conflict- the problem or struggle that the characters encounter which drives the plot forward and creates tension in the story.
- Plot- a sequence of events in a story.
- Setting- time and place when and where the action takes place in a story.
- Theme- a central idea in a literary work.

SUBTOPIC: 1.2.2.1. FORMS OF WRITTEN LITERATURE

Overview

Written literature is presented in various forms. In this subtopic, learners will discuss written literature and its forms, that is, prose, drama and poetry.

Specific competence: Learners to:

1.2.2.1.1. Demonstrate understanding of written literature.



Learning Activity 1 a: Discussing written literature

- ✓ Find out from the learners the meaning of literature.
- ✓ Divide the class into small groups and each group to be tasked to discuss the meaning and features of written literature provided to them on pieces of paper.
- ✓ Carry out a plenary session to share the different definitions and features of written literature discussed.

Consolidate the learners' presentations by highlighting the following points:

- ✓ Literature is broadly defined as written works that transmit culture, ideas and imagination. It includes both fictional and non-fictional texts.
- ✓ Written literature is defined as any form of literary work that is recorded in written form rather than being passed down orally.

Written literature has the following features:

- ✓ It includes texts that are created for various purposes, such as: storytelling, entertainment, education, or preserving history.
- ✓ Written literature employs specific diction, figurative language and syntax to convey themes and emotions.

- ✓ It often follows a structured plot with exposition, rising action, climax, falling action and resolution.
- ✓ It explores universal themes and uses symbolism for deeper meaning.
- ✓ Written literature allows for a permanent record of ideas, knowledge and artistic expression, making it an essential aspect of human culture.

Written literature differs from oral literature in the following ways:

- ✓ It is recorded in written form while oral literature is passed down through spoken word.
- ✓ Written literature is permanent and unchanged while oral literature relies on memory and can vary with retellings.
- ✓ Themes in written literature are usually universal whereas oral literature themes may be cultural specific (*teacher to come up with local examples of such themes*).

Suggested Teaching and Learning Materials: Plain papers, Pens, Written texts, etc.

Expected Standard: Understanding of written literature demonstrated accordingly.



Assessment Activity

1. Put the learners in pairs and then ask them to explore various definitions of written literature and distinguish written literature from oral literature. Later, sample pairs to share their findings with the entire class.



Summary:

- Conclude the activity by going through what written literature is as discussed earlier.
 - ✓ Written literature is defined as any form of literary work that is recorded in written form rather than being passed down orally.
 - ✓ It includes texts that are created for various purposes, such as storytelling, entertainment, education, or preserving history.
 - ✓ Written literature employs specific diction, figurative language, and syntax to convey themes and emotions.
 - ✓ It often follows a structured plot with exposition, rising action, climax, and resolution.

- ✓ It explores universal themes and uses symbolism for deeper meaning.
- ✓ Written literature allows for a permanent record of ideas, knowledge, and artistic expression, making it an essential aspect of human culture.

Written literature differs from oral literature in the following ways:

- ✓ It is recorded in written form while oral literature is passed down through spoken word.
- ✓ Written literature is permanent and unchanged while oral literature relies on memory and can vary with retellings.
- ✓ Themes in written literature are usually universal whereas oral literature themes may be cultural specific.



Learning Activity 1 b: Distinguishing forms of written literature

- ✓ Put learners in small groups and ask them to discuss forms of written literature. Each group to look at one form of written literature –i.e prose, poetry or drama.
- ✓ Ask group representatives to present their group's findings.
- ✓ Conduct a plenary session to discuss what has been presented.

Consolidate the learners' presentations by explaining the various forms of written literature as suggested below:

There are several forms of written literature, each with unique characteristics and purposes. This includes:

1. Prose- a form of literature that is written in continuous sentences and paragraphs. Prose is divided into two main types:

a) Fiction- a form of prose that is created from the imagination of the author. Fiction is inspired by real-life events but are not entirely factual. Examples of fiction include:

Novels – Long, detailed stories with developed characters and multiple themes.

Short Stories – Brief narratives with a clear plot and fewer characters.

Fables and Folktales – Traditional stories that teach moral lessons.

b) Non-Fiction- a form of prose based on real events, facts, and people which is intended to inform, educate, or provide arguments on various topics. Examples include:

Biographies and Autobiographies – Biographies tell the life story of a person written by someone else, while autobiographies are written by the person themselves.

Essays – Short pieces of writing that expresses personal views or arguments on a topic.

Diaries and Journals – Personal records of daily experiences and reflections.

2. Drama- a form of literature that is meant to be performed in front of an audience. It consists of dialogues and actions that bring the story to life. Types of drama include:

Tragedy – drama that often ends in sorrow.

Comedy – a humorous play that entertains and often has a happy ending.

Tragicomedy – drama that combines elements of both tragedy and comedy.

Historical Drama – a play based on real historical events.

3. Poetry- a form of literature that uses rhythmic and figurative language to express emotions and ideas. Poems are written in lines and stanzas. Some common types of poetry include:

Lyric Poetry – Expresses personal emotions and thoughts in form of a song.

Narrative Poetry – Tells a story in poetic form.

Epic Poetry – Long narrative poems about heroic figures and grand adventures.

Suggested Teaching and Learning Material: Plain papers, Pens, Written Texts, etc.

Expected Standard: Understanding of written literature demonstrated accordingly.



Assessment Activity

1. Through a written exercise, ask learners to discuss the various forms of written literature.



Summary

Conclude the lesson by highlighting the key points

There are several forms of written literature, each with unique characteristics and purposes. The main forms include:

1. Prose- a form of literature that is written in continuous sentences and paragraphs. Prose is divided into two main types:

a) Fiction- is a story that is created from the imagination of the writer. These stories may be inspired by real-life events but are not entirely factual. Examples of fiction include:

Novels – Long, detailed stories with developed characters and multiple themes.

Short Stories – Brief narratives with a clear plot and fewer characters.

Fables and Folktales – Traditional stories that teach moral lessons.

b) Non-Fiction- Non-fictional prose is based on real events, facts, and people. It is intended to inform, educate, or provide arguments on various topics. Examples include:

Biographies and Autobiographies – Biographies tell the life story of a person written by someone else, while autobiographies are written by the person themselves.

Essays – Short pieces of writing that express personal views or arguments on a topic.

Diaries and Journals – Personal records of daily experiences and reflections.

2. Drama- is a form of literature that is meant to be performed in front of an audience. It consists of dialogues and actions that bring the story to life. Some types of drama include:

Tragedy – drama that often ends in sorrow.

Comedy – a humorous play that entertains and often has a happy ending.

Tragicomedy – drama that combines elements of both tragedy and comedy.

Historical Drama – a play based on real historical events.

3. Poetry- is a form of literature that uses rhythmic and figurative language to express emotions, ideas, and imagery. Poems are written in lines and stanzas. Some common types of poetry include:

Lyric Poetry – Expresses personal emotions and thoughts in form of a song.

Narrative Poetry – Tells a story in poetic form.

Epic Poetry – Long narrative poems about heroic figures and grand adventures.

SUB-TOPIC: 1.2.2.2. PROSE

Overview

In our daily lives, we are usually exposed to some written texts that can be classified as prose. This is continuous writing which can either be fiction or non-fiction.

Specific competence: Learners to:

1.2.2.2.1. Demonstrate Understanding of Prose



Learning activity 1a – Discussing Prose and its structure (Prose: written text organized in paragraphs and chapters: fiction and non-fiction, exposition, rising action, climax, falling action and resolution...) – (non-fiction)

- Put learners in groups and distribute newspapers and biographies to different groups.
- Task each group to take note of the following:
 - (a) Whether or not the assigned materials are written in continuous sentences.
 - (b) Whether or not the passages or writings talk about real people.
- Plenary: Carry out a plenary session where different salient features noticed by the learners will be written on the chalk board.

Consolidate the learners’ presentation by highlighting the following:

- ✓ Prose writing is a form of continuous writing in the form of sentences and paragraphs.
- ✓ Prose can either be fiction or non-fiction.
- ✓ Fiction is based on the author’s imagination while non-fiction focusses on real events, people, places and shows a specific period of time.
- ✓ Examples of fiction include novels, short stories and novellas.
- ✓ Examples of non-fiction include newspapers, biographies, true adventure stories, essays and autobiographies.
- ✓ Prose has the following elements:
 - (a) Plot: sequence of events on which the story is centred. This helps the reader to picture what came first and see how it led to what came later.
 - (b) Character: a participant in the action of a story.
 - (c) Setting: time and the place in which the story takes place.

Suggested Teaching and Learning Materials: Newspapers, Excerpts of biographies, Flipcharts, Markers ...

Expected Standard: Understanding of prose demonstrated accordingly.



Assessment Activity

Pair the learners and let them interview one another and write each other’s biographies.



Summary

Wrap it all by going through the following points:

- ✓ Prose writing is a form of continuous writing in the form of sentences and paragraphs.

- ✓ Prose can either be fiction or non-fiction.
- ✓ Fiction is based on the author's imagination while non-fiction focusses on real events, people, places and shows a specific period of time.
- ✓ Examples of fiction are novels, short stories and novellas.
- ✓ Examples of non-fiction are newspapers, biographies, true adventure stories, essays and autobiographies.
- ✓ Prose has the following elements:
 - Plot: sequence of events on which the story is centred. This helps the reader to picture what came first and see how it led to what came later.
 - Character: a participant in the action of a story.
 - Setting: time and the place in which the story takes place.

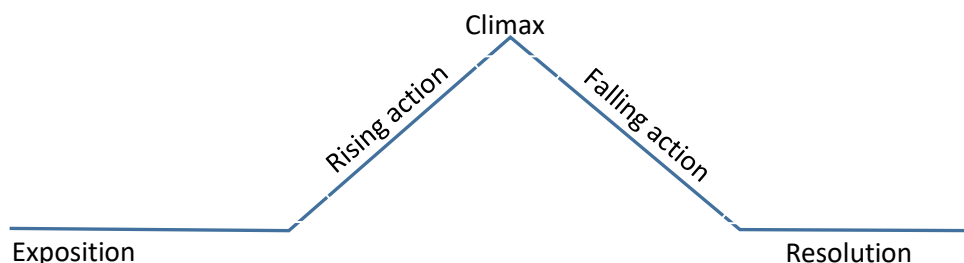


Learning Activity 1b: Discussing Prose and its structure (Prose: written text organized in paragraphs and chapters: fiction and non-fiction, exposition, rising action, climax, falling action and resolution...) – (fiction)

Display a flip chart with a short story and initiate a discussion based on its structure and elements.

- Generate questions that will enlist the following responses as you consolidate the learners' responses:
 - ✓ Fiction is based on the writer's imagination. Some examples are short stories, fables, folktales and drama.
 - ✓ Fiction has the following elements:
 - i. Plot - is the sequence of events on which the story is centred. It is centered on conflict and has the following structure:
 - a. Exposition: is where setting and characters are introduced.
 - b. Rising action: refers to all the events that happen in a story leading to the climax.
 - c. Climax: this is the most intense, exciting, or emotionally charged point in a story.
 - d. Falling action: these are events after the climax.
 - e. Resolution: this is the conclusion of the story where the conflict is resolved.

An example of a plot is presented below:



- ii. Setting: time and place in which the story takes place.

- iii. Character: a participant in the action of a story. Types of characters include:
- major character - is a figure at the centre of the story. The major character is sometimes called a protagonist whose conflict with an antagonist may spark the story's conflict. The story revolves around major characters.
 - minor character – is a figure who plays a small role in the story. The story can continue without the minor character.

Suggested Teaching and Learning Materials: Flip charts, markers and excerpts of short stories.

Expected Standard: Understanding of prose demonstrated accordingly.



Assessment Activity

Avail a short story and ask the learners the following questions:

- (1) Where is the story set?
- (2) Who is telling the story?
- (3) How many characters are in the story?
- (4) Identify the major and minor characters.

(Be free to come up with your own type of questions).



Summary

Conclude by highlighting the following:

- ✓ Fiction is based on the writer's imagination. Some examples are short stories, fables, folktales and drama.
- ✓ Fiction has the following elements:
 - i. Plot - is the sequence of events on which the story is centred. It is centered on conflict and has the following structure:
 - a. Exposition: is where setting and characters are introduced.
 - b. Rising action: refers to all the events that happen in a story leading to the climax.
 - c. Climax: this is the most intense, exciting, or emotionally charged point in a story.
 - d. Falling action: these are events after the climax.
 - e. Resolution: this is the conclusion of the story where the conflict is resolved.
 - iv. Setting: time and place in which the story takes place.
 - v. Character: a participant in the action of a story. Types of characters include:
 - major character - is a figure at the centre of the story. The major character is sometimes called a protagonist whose conflict with an antagonist may spark the story's conflict. The story revolves around major characters.
 - minor character – is a figure who plays a small role in the story. The story can continue without the minor character.



Learning Activity 1 a- Discussing elements of a short story (Plot)

- Put learners in groups and assign each group to discuss a short story and a Plot as one of its elements. (*Provide excerpts of short stories for the learners to consider in their discussion*)
- Ask group representatives to present the findings.
- Conduct a plenary session.

Consolidate the activity by highlighting the following:

Short Story

- ✓ A short story is a work of fiction, that is centred on one idea. Elements of a short story are: Plot, Character, Theme, Conflict, Setting, Point of view, Style and Tone.

Plot

- ✓ The sequence of events on which the story is centred. Which include the exposition, rising action, climax, falling action and resolution.

For details see Activity 1 b on page 18.

Plot Types

- ✓ Simple plot follows the traditional stages of plot from the beginning to the end.
- ✓ A complex plot is one that does not follow traditional stages of plot (see the diagram on page 19). For example, the story might start from the middle to the end.



Assessment Activity

- ✓ Administer an exercise for learners to identify the elements of Plot in a short story.



Summary

- Conclude by highlighting the following:

A short story is a work of fiction, that is centred on one idea. Elements of a short story are: Plot, Character, Theme, Conflict, Setting, Point of view, Style and Tone.

Plot

- ✓ The sequence of events on which a story is centred. It includes the exposition, rising action, climax, falling action and resolution.

Plot Types

- ✓ Simple plot follows the traditional stages of plot from the beginning to the end.

- ✓ A complex plot is one that does not follow traditional stages of plot. For example, the story might start from the middle to the end.



Learning Activity 1a (i) - Discussing elements of a short story (Character)

- Ask learners to explain what a character is in a story.
- Put learners in groups and assign each group to discuss Character as an element of a short Story. (*Provide excerpts of short stories for the learners to consider in their discussion*)
 - Ask group representatives to present the findings.
 - Conduct a plenary session.

Consolidate the activity by highlighting the following:

- ✓ A Character is a participant in the action of a story.
- ✓ Characters can be people, animals, objects or concepts.

Types of characters

- ✓ Protagonist - the main/ major character that is the focus of the story. The protagonist usually has a conflict or dilemma to resolve. This may be the hero/heroine of the story.
- ✓ Antagonist - is the character that opposes what the protagonist wants to achieve.
- ✓ Round character – is well-developed with both good and bad traits. Most major characters are round.
- ✓ Flat/Static character – unchanging character, with limited traits. Most minor characters are flat.
- ✓ Dynamic character- undergoes an important change in personality in the story.



Assessment Activity

- ✓ Administer an exercise for learners to identify the types of characters in short stories provided.



Summary

- Conclude by highlighting the following:
 - ✓ A Character is a participant in the action of a story.
 - ✓ Characters can be people, animals, objects or concepts.

Types of characters

- ✓ Protagonist - the main/ major character that is the focus of the story. The protagonist usually has a conflict or dilemma to resolve. This may be the hero/heroine of the story.
- ✓ Antagonist - is the character that opposes what the protagonist wants to achieve.

- ✓ Round character – is well-developed with both good and bad traits. Most major characters are round.
- ✓ Flat/Static character – unchanging character, with limited traits. Most minor characters are flat.
- ✓ Dynamic character- undergoes an important change in personality in the story.



Learning Activity 1a (ii) - Discussing elements of a short story (Theme)

- Introduce the concept of a theme to the learners and how the themes can be deduced in a short story.
- You may use the following short story;

The Dried-Up River

One scorching afternoon, Kalulu the hare hopped down to the river to fetch some water. But when he arrived, he found the riverbed cracked and dry.

“Oh no!” Kalulu cried. “The river is gone!”

Just then, Hippo came lumbering out of the bush, looking tired and dusty. “Kalulu, do you know where the water has gone?” he asked.

Kalulu shook his head. “I fear it has not rained in many moons. The trees are fewer now, and people keep cutting them down. The earth is too hot, and the clouds no longer come.”

Hippo sighed. “When I was young, this river flowed all year. Now even my skin burns from the sun.”

Kalulu sat on a rock, thinking. “We must act, Hippo. If we plant more trees, use less firewood, and care for the earth, maybe the rains will return.”

Hippo nodded slowly. “You are wise, little hare. Let us tell the others.”

From that day on, Kalulu and Hippo became messengers, spreading the word about protecting nature. The animals began planting trees, stopping bushfires, and keeping the land clean.

Soon, small streams trickled back into the riverbed. And after some time, the rains came again

Theme: Climate Change

When we care for the environment, the environment cares for us. Climate change affects us all, but together we can make a difference.

- Put learners in groups and assign each group to identify and discuss the themes that are in the short story provided. (*Provide excerpts of short stories for the learners to consider in their discussion*)
- Ask group representatives to present the findings.
- Conduct a plenary session.

Consolidate the activity by highlighting the following:

Theme

- ✓ This is the central or main idea in a short story.
- ✓ It is often the reason the author writes the story.
- ✓ The theme can be deduced through character behavior.
- ✓ Many stories are written with the underlying purpose of making an important observation about society.
- ✓ A story can have more than one theme.
- ✓ The following are examples of some common themes:
 - a. **Good vs Evil.** This is a common theme that runs through many stories. A protagonist will often have to struggle against evil, whether this is coming from an external source or from within themselves.
 - b. **Injustice.** This may be political, economic, social, religious ...
- ✓ Besides these, other common themes include: Love, Sin, Hate, Death, Growth, Pride, Climate Change...



Assessment Activity

- ✓ Administer an exercise for learners to deduce themes in a short story.



Summary

- Conclude the lesson by highlighting the key points.

Theme

- ✓ This is the central or main idea in a short story.
- ✓ It is often the reason the author writes the story.
- ✓ The theme can be deduced through character behavior.
- ✓ Many stories are written with the underlying purpose of making an important observation about society.
- ✓ A story can have more than one theme.



Learning Activity 1a (iii) - Discussing elements of a short story (Conflict)

- Introduce the concept of conflict to the learners and how conflict can be identified in a short story (*Refer to the story above on theme*).
- Put learners in groups and assign each group to discuss conflict as an element of a short story. (*Provide excerpts of short stories for the learners to consider in their discussion*)
 - Ask group representatives to present the findings.
 - Conduct a plenary session.

Consolidate the activity by highlighting the following:

Conflict

- ✓ This is the problem or struggle that the character encounters which drives the plot forward and creates tension in the story.
- ✓ The conflict of a story is often a struggle between the protagonist and antagonist.
- ✓ This could represent the struggle between good and evil, or how two people reconcile their differences in order to fall in love. However, the conflict might be between the protagonist and nature, society or within themselves.
- ✓ This conflict is what builds up the story, creating suspense and tension until it reaches the climax.

Types of Conflict

- ✓ Internal - Struggle within oneself.
- ✓ External- Struggle with a force outside oneself.
Character vs. Character- Struggles against other characters.
Character vs. Nature- Struggles against animals, weather, environment...
Character vs. Society- Struggles against ideas, practices, or customs of others...



Assessment Activity

- ✓ Administer an exercise for learners to identify and explain the conflict(s) in a short story.



Summary

- Conclude the lesson by highlighting the key points.

Conflict

- ✓ This is the problem or struggle that the character encounters which drives the plot forward and creates tension in the story.
- ✓ The conflict of a story is often a struggle between the protagonist and antagonist.
- ✓ This could represent the struggle between good and evil, or how two people reconcile their differences in order to fall in love. However, the conflict might be between the protagonist and nature, society or within themselves.
- ✓ This conflict is what builds up the story, creating suspense and tension until it reaches the climax.



Learning Activity 1a (iv) - Discussing elements of a short story (Setting)

- Based on the story ‘**the Dried up River**’, ask the learners to identify a) time when the story is taking place b) The place where the story happens.
- Provide short stories for the learners to identify setting in their groups.
- Ask group representatives to present the findings.
- Conduct a plenary session.

Consolidate the activity by highlighting the following:

Setting

- ✓ This is time and place:
Place- where the story takes place.
Time- when the story takes place.
- ✓ Some stories have more than one setting.



Assessment Activity

- ✓ Administer an exercise on setting as a concept of a short story.



Summary

- Conclude the lesson by highlighting the key points.

Setting:

- ✓ This is time and place:
Place- where the story takes place.
Time- when the story takes place.
- ✓ Some stories have more than one setting.



Learning Activity 1a (v) - Discussing elements of a short story (Point of View)

- Based on the story ‘**The Dried up River**’, ask the learners to identify the point of view of the short story.
- Provide short stories for the learners to identify the point of view in their groups.
- Ask group representatives to present the findings.
- Conduct a plenary session.

Consolidate the activity by highlighting the following:

Point of view

- ✓ The perspective or angle from which the story is told.

Types of point of view:

- ✓ **First Person:** (I, me, we) when the character is the narrator of the story.
- ✓ **Second Person:** (you, your, yours) when narrator talks to the reader. (*Not commonly used.*)
- ✓ **Third Person:** (names of people, him, and her) when the narrator is someone outside the story.



Assessment Activity

- ✓ Administer an exercise to learners to identify point of view in short stories.



Summary

- Conclude the lesson by highlighting the key points.

Point of view:

- ✓ The perspective or angle from which the story is told.
- ✓ **First Person:** (I, me, we) when the character is the narrator of the story.
- ✓ **Second Person:** (you, your, yours) when narrator talks to the reader. (*Not commonly used.*)
- ✓ **Third Person:** (names of people, him, and her) when the narrator is someone outside the story.

The story below brings out the following concepts: Theme, Setting, Point of view and Conflict

The Dried-Up River

One scorching afternoon, Kalulu the hare hopped down to the river to fetch some water. But when he arrived, he found the riverbed cracked and dry.

“Oh no!” Kalulu cried. “The river is gone!”

Just then, Hippo came lumbering out of the bush, looking tired and dusty. “Kalulu, do you know where the water has gone?” he asked.

Kalulu shook his head. “I fear it has not rained in many moons. The trees are fewer now, and people keep cutting them down. The earth is too hot, and the clouds no longer come.”

Hippo sighed. “When I was young, this river flowed all year. Now even my skin burns from the sun.”

Kalulu sat on a rock, thinking. “We must act, Hippo. If we plant more trees, use less firewood, and care for the earth, maybe the rains will return.”

Hippo nodded slowly. “You are wise, little hare. Let us tell the others.”

From that day on, Kalulu and Hippo became messengers, spreading the word about protecting nature. The animals began planting trees, stopping bushfires, and keeping the land clean.

Soon, small streams trickled back into the riverbed. And after some time, the rains came again

Theme:

When we care for the environment, the environment cares for us. Climate change affects us all, but together we can make a difference.

Conflict:

Man vs. Nature (Environmental Conflict) – The main conflict is the disappearance of the river due to climate change caused by deforestation and lack of rainfall. Kalulu and Hippo are struggling with the consequences of human actions that are harming the environment.

There’s also a subtle Man vs. Society element – Kalulu and Hippo must convince others to change their behavior to save the environment.

Point of View:

Third-Person The story is told by a narrator who focuses mainly on Kalulu’s thoughts and actions, but not all the characters' inner feelings are revealed. The narrator describes events as an observer, using "he" and "they"

Setting:

Time:

A present-day or near-present setting during a time of drought.

Place:

A Zambian village environment, specifically near a river that has dried up, with surrounding bushland and signs of deforestation.

Specific competence: Learners to:

1.2.2.2.2. Compose short stories



Learning Activity 1 b: Composing short stories (short stories...on cross cutting themes such as gender, climate change, corruption, governance...)

- Lead a discussion on the characteristics of a short story.
- Divide the class into groups and task each group to plan the stages of plot for a given short story.
- Let each group representative present their plan of a short story to the class.
- Conduct a class discussion of what each group presented based on their plan of a short story.

Consolidate the activity by highlighting the following:

Characteristics of a short story

- Short and can usually be read in one sitting.
- Concise information offered in the story is relevant to the plot.
- It is captivating.
- The plot is built around one character, place and idea.

Composing a short story

Compose a short story by using stages of a plot which will include the elements of plot.

1. Title of the Story: _____

2. Characters: _____

3. Stages of a plot

Draw a diagram of the plot and fill in the key parts below:

Stages of Plot What Happens in the Story?

Exposition _____

Rising Action _____

Climax _____

Falling Action _____

Resolution _____

4. Conflict (Tick one):

☐ Person vs Person

☐ Self vs Self

☐ Person vs Nature

☐ Person vs Society

☐ Other: _____

Brief explanation of the conflict: _____

5. Theme: What is the message or lesson of the story? _____

6. Point of View: _____

Suggested Teaching and Learning Material: Projector, Computer, Phone, Flip Charts, Markers, Excerpts Storybooks ...

Expected Standard: Short stories composed creatively.



Assessment Activity

- Give individual work to learners to compose a short story bearing the key features they learnt in the activity. (Refer to suggested list of short story topics)



Summary

Conclude the lesson by highlighting the key points.

Characteristics of a short story

- Short and can usually be read in one sitting.
- Concise information offered in the story is relevant to the plot.
- It is captivating.
- The plot is built around one character, place and idea.

Suggested Short Story Topics (Cross Cutting Issues)

The suggested topics are not exhaustive. Teachers are free to come up with their own topics in the said thematic areas.

1. Climate Change

“The Day the Rains Never Came” – A boy tries to save his village from a long drought.

“Tree for a Dream” – A girl plants trees to fulfil a promise to her grandfather.

“The Plastic Monster” – Children discover a strange creature made of plastic waste invading their river.

2. Education for Sustainable Development

“The School Garden” – Learners start a garden project that changes their community.

“The Lesson That Changed Everything” – A teacher’s lesson inspires learners to solve a community problem.

“The Recycled School” – A school built from recycled materials becomes famous.

3. Digital Literacy

“The Hacker’s Trap” – A learner clicks on a suspicious link and learns a big lesson.

“The Online Genius” – A shy girl uses digital tools to win a national science competition.

4. Collaborative and Inclusive Learning

“The Group Project” – Learners from different backgrounds work together and succeed.

“My Desk Mate” – A top learner learns to understand and support a struggling classmate.

“The Silent Partner” – A learner with a hearing disability shows incredible intelligence

5. Entrepreneurship

“Banana Biscuits Business” – Two friends start a biscuit business after school.

“Market Day Miracle” – A girl sells doormats to help her sick brother.

“The Chips Maker” – A creative learner turns a science lesson into a chips business.

6. Anti-Corruption

“The Stolen Prize” – A learner wins a competition unfairly and faces the consequences.

“The Honest Prefect” – A school leader refuses a bribe and gains real respect.

“The Missing Books” – Learners uncover a scheme involving stolen school supplies.

7. Global Citizenship

“Pen-Pals across the Ocean” – A Zambian learner writes to a friend in China and learns valuable lessons.

“The United Team” – Learners from different classes must work together to win a competition.

“The Earth is our Home” – A girl starts a campaign after learning about pollution in Kafue River.

8. Human Rights

“A Voice for Grace” – A girl stands up for a classmate being bullied.

“The Locked Door” – A boy discovers a friend being denied his rights but helps him.

“The Protest Song” – A young singer writes a song about justice and peace.

9. Cultural Diversity

“The Festival of Unity” – Learners from different schools of Zambia plan a joint celebration.

“The Girl Who Danced” – A city girl surprises everyone by performing a traditional dance.

“One School, Many Languages” – Learners present traditional dances from different regions of Zambia.

10. Renewable and Clean Energy

“The Solar Lamp” – A boy builds a solar lamp to help his sister study at night.

“Power for the Village” – Learners campaign for a clean energy solution in their community.

“The Bicycle That Lights Up” – A clever invention changes a family’s life.

11. Health and Nutrition

“Lunchbox Secrets” – A curious learner learns about healthy eating from a friend.

“The Sugar Trap” – A story about a boy who learns the dangers of junk food.

“Water from the Sky” – Learners create a rainwater harvesting system to improve irrigation.

12. Drug and Substance Abuse

“The Dark Corner” – A story of a learner who starts using drugs and gets saved by a friend.

“The Wrong Crowd” – A learner joins a gang but finds a way out through sports.

“Just One Sip” – A party takes a bad turn, teaching a big lesson about alcohol.

13. Mental Health

“The Boy Who Wore a Mask” – A learner hides his sadness until a teacher helps him.

“The Butterfly Inside” – A shy girl discovers her confidence through poetry.

“Storm in My Head” – A story about anxiety.

14. Social and Emotional Learning

“The Angry Boy” – A hot-tempered learner learns to control his emotions.

“A Smile for Mama” – A girl uses kindness to help her mother through hard times.

“The Apology Letter” – A story of forgiveness and emotional growth between friends.

15. Financial Education

“My First Savings” – A girl saves money through Patumba to buy a gift for her mother.

“The K5 Mistake” – A learner learns a lesson about how to spend money wisely.

“Budget Wars” – Siblings compete on how to manage their pocket money.

16. Special and Inclusive Education

“The Artist with No Hands” – A story about a boy who paints with his feet.

“Maria’s Voice” – A girl who uses sign language becomes a school headgirl.

“The Wheelchair Race” – An inclusive sports day teaches everyone a lesson on equality.

BIBLIOGRAPHY

Cuddon, J. A. (2013). *A dictionary of literary terms and literary theory*. Oxford: John Wiley & Sons.

Elements of Literature (Fifth course) (2009). New York: Winston, Inc.

Gioia, D. (2019). *Poetry as Enchantment: Performance and the Art of Orality*. Harvard University Press.

Kamwengo-Imasiku, M. (2017). *Literature in English: A course book for learners, Grade 10*. Marvel Publishers.

Kennedy, X. J., & Gioia, D. (2016). *Literature: An introduction to fiction, poetry, drama, and writing*. Boston: Pearson.

Macmillan Literature Series (1987), *Introducing Literature*. New York: Seriband Educational Publishers.

Mc Dougal, L & Company (1989), *Reading Literature*. Illinois: Evaston.

Meyer, M. (2017). *The Bedford introduction to literature*. Boston: Bedford/St. Martin's.

Ministry of Education. (2023). *Education for sustainable development: Policy on Education*. Government Printers, Lusaka: Zambia

Ministry of Education. (2023). *2023 Zambia Education Curriculum Framework*. Government Printers, Lusaka: Zambia

Ministry of Education. (2025). *Literature in English Form 1 Teaching Module Term 1*. Lusaka: Zambia.

Novak, J. (2020). *The Spoken Word Revolution: Poetic Techniques in Performance Poetry*. Routledge.

Sinyangwe, M. (2019). *Literature in English: A student's peer in poetry analysis*. Bookforce.

Somers-Willett, S. B. A. (2018). *The Cultural Politics of Slam Poetry*. University of Michigan Press

SAMPLE LESSON PLAN

NAME OF TEACHER:

DATE: 13/ 09/ 2025

CLASS: Form 1

TIME: 07:00-08:20

SUBJECT: Literature in English

DURATION: 80 minutes

TOPIC: 1.2.2 Written Literature

TOTAL NO. OF LEARNERS: 60

SUB-TOPIC: 1.2.2.4 Poetry

GENERAL COMPETENCES:

- Collaboration: Learners to participate fully in groups and play the assigned roles or tasks.
- Communication: Effectively share one's thoughts and emotions, and understand others.

SPECIFIC COMPETENCES: 1.2.2.4.1. Demonstrate understanding of Poetry

RATIONALE: This lesson is on poetry. This is particularly on form, line and stanza. Discussion, collaboration, question and answer will be used in order to develop learners' understanding of poetry. This is the first lesson in a series of three in a week.

PRIOR KNOWLEDGE: Learners have general understanding of poetry.

REFERENCES:

- 2024 Literature in English Syllabus Form 1 pages 8 – 9.
- 2025 Literature in English Teaching Module Form 1 Term 3 page...
-

LEARNING ENVIRONMENT (*Teacher to choose the most applicable environment*)

Natural environment: school surrounding, play-ground...

Artificial environment: classroom, pictures, school hall... (*classroom is applicable for this lesson*)

Technological environment: e-learning websites... (*radio, projector, computers, etc are applicable for this lesson*)

TEACHING AND LEARNING MATERIALS/RESOURCES: radio, computer, projector, recorded poems, flip charts and markers.

EXPECTED STANDARD: Understanding of poetry demonstrated adequately.

LESSON PROGRESSION:

STAGES	TEACHER'S ROLE	LEARNERS' ROLE	PERFORMANCE INDICATOR
INTRODUCTION <i>(5 minutes)</i>	Introduce the lesson by asking learners what they know about poetry.	Give responses about what poetry is.	Learners say what they know about poetry.
DEVELOPMENT Step 1: Group work <i>(15 Minutes)</i>	Divide learners in groups and share excerpts of a poem written on A4 papers. For example, 'Zambia is Getting Warmer' and let them read it.	Take-turns to read the poem in groups.	Learners take-turns reading the poem.
Step 2: Class discussion <i>(15 Minutes)</i>	Lead a class discussion on what a poem is and its elements (form, line and stanza)	Actively take part in the discussion of what a poem is and its elements (form, line and stanza)	Learners take note of the elements of poetry, which are form, line and stanza.
Step 3: Class discussion <i>(10 Minutes)</i>	Consolidate the lesson by highlighting key aspects of poetry and its elements as explained by the learners.	- Explain poetry and its elements (form, line and stanza): - Poetry- is a form of literature that uses rhythmic and figurative language to express emotions and ideas. - A poem is a literary work that expresses emotions and ideas. - Poems are usually Didactic (teach) or Aesthetic (beauty). - Form- the structure of a poem and collection of lines with a	Learners explain poetry and its elements which are form, line and stanza.

		metrical rhythm in a poem. • Stanza: a division of a poem consisting of two or more lines arranged together as a unit. • Line: a unit of writing into which a poem or play is divided.	
Step 4: Assessment Activity <i>(30 Minutes)</i> Home work	Provide a poem and ask learners to identify the elements of poetry in that poem: form, line and stanza. Assign learners to go and research on the other elements of poetry: verse, rhyme and rhythm.	• Individually write down the elements of poetry in the given poem: form, line and stanza. Attend to the assigned homework on the other elements of poetry: verse, rhyme and rhythm.	Learners give correct responses to the given exercise. Submission of homework in the next lesson.
Conclusion <i>(5 minutes)</i>	• Summarize the day's lesson through question and answer such as: • What do you understand by the following elements of poetry: form, line and stanza?	• Give answers to the posed questions highlighting the elements of poetry which are form, line and stanza.	Learners highlight what poetry is and its elements: form, line and stanza.

LESSON EVALUATION:

Teacher Evaluation:

.....

.....

.....

Learner Evaluation:

.....
.....
.....